



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

RESTORATION & PROPERTY SERVICES RECOVERY • CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Receivables Recovery for Restoration Contractors

Recovering restoration and water-mitigation balances — including claims the carrier already paid — on pure contingency

Prepared for **NorthBound Operating Partners** • September 2026

When the claim was paid and the contractor still wasn't

To the NorthBound case management team — the hardest dollars a restoration company collects aren't disputed invoices. They're the jobs where the loss was documented, the carrier issued payment, and the money landed somewhere other than the contractor who did the work.

Two very different files sit inside one aging report. A property owner who received the carrier's check and never endorsed it over is a collectable receivable. Proceeds sitting with a public adjuster, a law firm or another third party is a fund-diversion question — it moves under demand sometimes, and needs counsel the rest of the time. We will tell you which is which before anything is placed.

Southwest Recovery Services is an outsourced receivables recovery partner working commercial and consumer balances on **pure contingency since 2004**, licensed and operating in Florida with recovery reach in all 50 states. You place through a secure portal that takes your job-costing or AR-aging export. No recovery, no fee.

Two decades recovering contractor receivables

A restoration and property-services book built on documented job files, mixed commercial and consumer balances, and compliant outreach in every state we work.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY

FINANCIAL SERVICES
Review

FSR • TOP 10 LIST
2025 Recognition

INTERNATIONAL
Business Times

CFO Tech
Outlook

insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



 ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

Your six questions — answered in order

Exactly what you asked, plus the distinctions that decide what this portfolio actually recovers.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. Commercial and consumer in Florida	Both. SWRS is licensed and actively collecting in Florida on commercial B2B balances and on consumer accounts. The two are worked under different rules and by different teams — consumer files carry FDCPA, Regulation F and the Florida Consumer Collection Practices Act, commercial files do not. Segment them at placement and both recover better.
2. Public adjusters, law firms, contractors & third parties holding proceeds	Yes, with an honest line drawn. Where a third party holds funds owed to you, we identify and contact the holder, document the chain of payment from the carrier forward, and press for release. Where proceeds sit in an attorney trust account or with a licensed public adjuster who refuses, the remedy is legal — interpleader, a Florida DFS licensing complaint, a bar grievance, or suit. We will say so rather than bill you cycles against a file that needs counsel.
3. Carrier paid, you weren't	This is the strongest part of your portfolio. Where the carrier issued payment to the insured and the insured never paid the contractor, the money demonstrably existed and the obligation is documented — that combination recovers materially better than an ordinary aged balance. Proof of carrier payment, the signed work authorization and the certificate of completion are what make these move.
4. Fees	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no monthly minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover. Skip tracing is included, not billed separately. Litigation is never filed without your written authorization on a file-by-file basis; court costs and any filing fees are quoted to you before suit and are the only out-of-pocket item in the relationship. We quote your rate once we've seen a representative sample of the aging.
5. Expected recovery	Age governs. At 12–24 months at placement this book sits toward the lower half of our restoration and contractor range, not the top of it — the case studies opposite show that spread honestly. The carrier-paid subset outperforms the rest of the file. We give an age-banded read on a representative sample before any account is worked, and we do not guarantee recovery.

6. Assignment & escalation

Bulk-upload an aging or job-costing export through the portal — we map your columns, no re-keying. Files are scored and assigned by balance, age and account type, with commercial and consumer routed separately. Outreach begins within 24–48 hours of a documented placement and escalates through multi-channel contact, skip tracing on the debtor and any third party holding funds, credit reporting where the account qualifies, and a recommendation for or against legal action — which only proceeds on your authorization.

THE SWRS CLIENT PORTAL**Built to take a job file, not just an invoice number**

Every placement is managed through our secure portal — built so a restoration file arrives with the documentation that actually resolves it.

AGING-EXPORT PLACEMENT

Upload from QuickBooks, Sage, Xactimate-adjacent job costing or a spreadsheet — we map your columns.

SECURE DOCUMENT EXCHANGE

Work authorizations, certificates of completion, carrier correspondence, proof of payment and assignments — the paper that wins these files.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports on demand, per client entity.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a customer makes directly to you, so balances stay accurate and no one is over-contacted.

► **Portal Video Tour**

SWRS Restoration & Contractor Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's restoration, construction and trades book, anonymized by sector. The spread is shown honestly — a 12–24 month book behaves like the lower half of this range, not the top.

DISASTER RESTORATION

CONTRACTOR

Fire & water restoration

\$157K recovered

of ~\$580K placed

27% recovered

PLUMBING & MECHANICAL

CONTRACTOR

Service & repair trades

\$312K recovered

of ~\$779K placed

40% recovered

CONSTRUCTION & BUILD-OUT

FIRM

Commercial interiors

\$180K recovered

of ~\$974K placed

18% recovered

REGIONAL GENERAL

CONTRACTOR

Ground-up & renovation

\$73K recovered

of ~\$496K placed

15% recovered

SPECIALTY RESTORATION

FIRM

Structural drying & repair

\$61K recovered

of ~\$498K placed

12% recovered

WATER & FIRE MITIGATION

FRANCHISE

Regional mitigation

\$18K recovered

of ~\$290K placed

6% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

THE AGING CURVE

Why a restoration balance decays the way it does

A restoration receivable is most collectable while the loss is fresh in everyone's mind and the carrier file is still open. Once the claim closes, the adjuster moves on and the proceeds have been spent, leverage drops sharply — which is exactly what a 12–24 month book is describing.

WHAT STILL MOVES AT 12–24 MONTHS

Files where carrier payment is documented.
The money existed, the obligation is provable,
and that evidence survives aging better than
an ordinary invoice does.

WHAT THE NEXT BOOK SHOULD DO

A standing rule to place at 90–120 days past
due recovers materially more than letting
balances drift, and on contingency there is no
cost to placing early.

Recovery figures vary by portfolio; SWRS gives an honest, age-banded read on a representative sample before any accounts are worked. No recovery is guaranteed.

Following the money the claim already released

Restoration receivables fail in a small number of specific ways, and each one has a different answer. Sorting the file correctly at intake is most of the work.



Carrier paid, contractor unpaid

Documented proof of payment plus the signed work authorization turns a stale balance into a provable obligation.



Third parties holding proceeds

We identify and contact public adjusters, counsel and other holders, document the payment chain, and flag the files that need legal escalation rather than more outreach.



Commercial and consumer, separated

Two teams, two rulebooks. Florida consumer balances are worked under FDCPA, Regulation F and the FCCPA; commercial B2B is not consumer debt.



Multi-entity placement

Portfolio and family-office operators place several operating companies under one relationship with per-entity reporting.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that trims DSO and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for NorthBound Operating Partners

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Refusal vs. Dispute

Contested & withheld balances
· PDF

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The Placement File Standard

What a recoverable file contains · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

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Let's read the file before anyone quotes a rate.

A 30-minute call to identify the placing entity, walk a representative sample of the aging, separate the carrier-paid accounts from the third-party-held ones, and put a contingency rate against what is actually recoverable.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

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